

Aerodynamic bicycle wheel

Following research, three-spoked bicycle wheels were developed into shapes that move quickly and easily.

These wheels maximize the bikes' efficiency for racing.



Material facts

Some people believe these materials were invented for the space program, when in fact they were just used by it. The heat-resistant plastic, Teflon, for example, was invented in 1938 and later used on space suits and heat shields.



Teflon is commonly used as a non-stick covering for cooking pans. It is also a stain-resistant fabric protector.



Velcro was invented in the 1940s and later used during the Apollo missions to hold tools and equipment in place at zero gravity, when they would otherwise have floated off. It is now used on the International Space Station. Velcro is also used to secure clothing.

Things like these

During the 1960s onwards, US space agency NASA adapted everyday objects for use in its space program.



NASA made its own smoke detector with adjustable sensitivity. It also used smoke detectors on Skylab, the space station launched in 1973, to detect toxic vapours.

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A type of bar coding was used by NASA to keep track of spacecraft components.

Quartz clocks were first used in the 1920s. In the 1960s, NASA worked to produce a highly accurate quartz clock.

